



DISABILITY AND ACCESS
THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

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CONFIDENTIAL

September 8, 2026

Reference: Jennie "Jennie" Tchao JT46459 for INFORMATION/INTERACTION DESIGN 320U 30525

Dear MCQUAID, MICHAEL:

Jennie "Jennie" Tchao is registered with Disability and Access for the Fall 2026 semester due to a disability that has been verified by D&A. In accordance with university policy and federal law, this student is entitled to the following accommodations to remove barriers to access that may exist in your course. Jennie "Jennie" will work with you directly to determine how these accommodations may apply in your course and to discuss how they can best meet the essential requirements of the course.

Classroom Accommodations:

- Flexibility with deadlines; the amount of flexibility should be based on the structure of the course.
- Flexibility with attendance; the amount of flexibility should be based on the structure of the course. Student and instructor should complete, sign, and return the provided Attendance Policy Addendum to D&A in order to be officially recognized.

Testing Accommodations:

- One and one half the allotted time for any timed activity such as taking tests and completing work in class unless speed is the factor being tested
- Test location in a reduced distraction environment
- 5-10 minute breaks during exams

Faculty and departments are responsible for providing the classroom and testing accommodations listed above. If you have questions about how these accommodations apply in your course or have concerns about altering the essential requirements of your course please contact this student's **Access Coordinator, Josh Carra, at joshua.carra@austin.utexas.edu**. For more information about providing classroom and testing accommodations, visit the Faculty and Staff section of our website at <https://disability.utexas.edu/supporting-students>.

Conversations with students should focus on the provision of accommodations and the barriers in the course rather than on specific details of the student's diagnosis or disability(ies). Please do not ask the student questions related to their condition or diagnosis as these are confidential.

D&A works in partnership with faculty and staff to ensure students with disabilities have equal access to the University of Texas at Austin. We appreciate your efforts in providing an accessible educational experience for this student.

Sincerely,

Sandra Cash

Sandra Cash, PhD

Executive Director, Student Disability and Accessibility Services

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The University of Texas at Austin Disability and Access

Attendance Policy Addendum

Student Name: _____ **EID:** _____
Instructor Name: _____ **Course Number:** _____
Access Coordinator: Josh Carra **Semester:** _____

The student delivering this form has presented documentation stating that the nature of their disability may affect attendance in class, has registered with Disability and Access (D&A), and is approved for an accommodation related to course attendance. The objective of this form is to facilitate a collaborative discussion about essential course requirements, clarify expectations, and provide an opportunity for students to share possible attendance issues while creating a plan for the semester.

The course syllabus is a document that allows instructors to outline expectations and requirements of a course so that students know what to expect. Federal law requires Universities to consider reasonable modifications to attendance policies when deemed a reasonable accommodation by D&A. Instructors are responsible for completing this form and providing the approved accommodations as part of the university's compliance obligations.

Please note:

- Instructors are not allowed to inquire about a student's specific diagnosis or symptoms.
- Students are not required to submit any documentation for a disability related absence.
- The student and instructor should complete this form together in a private setting.
- The student and instructor should keep a copy of the signed document. The student should return the completed document to D&A as soon as possible. This can be submitted to access@austin.utexas.edu. This accommodation is officially recognized by D&A upon receipt of the completed form, and will be in effect as of the instructor's signature date. A copy should be provided to assistant instructors, teaching assistants, or graduate assistants responsible for grading attendance.

Student, please complete the following two questions:

1. When my disability causes me to be absent, I will typically be absent for:

- ☐ One day
- ☐ Two-Five days
- ☐ More than five days

2. Based on the nature of your disability, how much advance notice can you provide to your instructor regarding your absence(s)?

- ☐ One week or more
- ☐ Within 24 hours
- ☐ Unpredictable, I may not be able to provide any advance notice

Student and instructor, the following questions are based on factors outlined by the U.S. Department of Education Office of Civil Rights to consider when evaluating flexibility with attendance and should be discussed together.

1. Is there significant interaction during class between the instructor and students and among students?
☐ Yes, please describe: _____
☐ No
2. Do student contributions constitute a significant component of learning?
☐ Yes, student contributions are significant to the way students learn in this course.
☐ No
3. Does the fundamental nature of the course rely upon student participation as essential to the learning method?
☐ Yes, in-class activities and participation are an essential requirement in this course.
☐ No
4. Please list any class dates or deadlines that are not flexible because they pertain to in-class educational experiences that cannot be replicated outside of the classroom.

5. When a student is absent, what opportunities are available for the student to complete work or demonstrate knowledge that was discussed in class?
☐ Meet during instructor's office hours to discuss material
☐ Extra credit opportunities
☐ Additional written assignments
☐ Course videos
☐ There are no other opportunities
☐ Other: _____
6. If the student misses class on the day of an exam/quiz, what flexibility can be provided?
☐ Student will be given a make-up exam that must be taken within ____ calendar days of original exam date.
☐ Exams cannot be made up; the remaining exams will be re-weighted.
☐ The student may take the optional final in lieu of one missed exam.
☐ Student may submit an alternate assignment.
☐ Other (please specify) _____
☐ None; there are no exams in this course

7. If the student misses class on the date of a deadline, what flexibility can you provide?
- ☐ Submit assignment during office hours within _____ calendar days of the deadline.
 - ☐ Electronic/online submission of assignment within _____ calendar days of the deadline.
 - ☐ Submit next class period
 - ☐ Other: _____
 - ☐ None; there are no deadlines in this course.
8. How does any student get copies of class notes or other information presented in class when they are absent? (Note taking accommodations are not required to be provided to a student when they are absent.)
- ☐ Information is available online.
 - ☐ The instructor or TA will email notes to the student.
 - ☐ The student should attend office hours or schedule an appointment.
 - ☐ The student and instructor will set up a group of fellow students to contact.
 - ☐ Other: _____
9. Clear communication with the instructor is critical and expected in utilizing this accommodation. How will the student and instructor communicate?
- ☐ Email: _____

Student Email
Instructor Email
 - ☐ Phone call: _____

Student Phone
Instructor Phone
 - ☐ Communication in Canvas
 - ☐ The student does not need to contact me.
 - ☐ Other: _____
10. What timeframe will the student communicate with the instructor when absent? (Some student's disabilities are unpredictable in nature and absences may be unexpected, therefore advanced notice of absences may not be reasonable. See question 2.)
- ☐ Within the day
 - ☐ Within 2 calendar days
 - ☐ Within the week
 - ☐ Other: _____
11. Per your syllabus or course policy, how many class meetings may a student be absent without penalty?
 Answer: _____
12. Please state a specific number of additional class meetings a student may miss for disability-related reasons before needing to meet and discuss their progress in the class.
 Answer: _____

If a student exceeds the maximum amount of flexibility originally discussed, student and instructor should revisit this document, discuss academic progress, and allow the student the opportunity to decide whether continued enrollment in the course is feasible. Students who miss a significant number of classes with a heavy emphasis on interaction and participation may not be able to fulfill course requirements/expectations.

While the instructor is required to provide flexibility to their course attendance policies, there are reasonable limits to the amount of flexibility that is appropriate. There may be times when students do not pass the course even when an instructor has provided flexibility with attendance or deadlines.

By signing below, the student and instructor have agreed to flexibility outlined in this form. The above questions have been discussed and answered as thoroughly as possible. Additionally, the student agrees to (1) only use this accommodation for disability-related absences, (2) maintain regular communication with the instructor regarding these absences, and (3) to contact the instructor if they suspect they may go over the maximum number of excused absences, as documented above.

If the student or instructor has any questions regarding the provisions outlined in this form, they should contact the student's assigned coordinator, Josh Carra, at joshua.carra@austin.utexas.edu.

Student Signature

Date

Instructor Signature

Date

Access Coordinator Signature

Date